

2026 range guide

Brakes - hydraulic disc calipers

Halvard R4 four-piston caliper

The R4 is the four-piston caliper in the Halvard range and the one to fit if you are heavy on the brakes, ride loaded, or spend descents dragging a lever. Against the two-piston R2 it gives more pad area and a longer service life, at the cost of weight and a slightly firmer initial bite. The body is a two-piece forging with a bridge across the pistons, which is what keeps the flex out of it under load. Pistons are phenolic rather than alloy, so less heat is carried into the fluid on a long descent. The R4 is supplied with sintered pads as standard. Sintered pads take longer to bed in, are noisier in the wet for the first few rides, and last roughly twice as long as organic. Mount is post mount, front or rear, and the caliper takes the Halvard four-piston pad shape. Fitting a larger rotor than the frame mount is cut for needs the correct adapter for the position, and front and rear adapters are not interchangeable. Hose fitting is the current Halvard standard. It is not compatible with the 2019 R2 body without a new olive and insert, which is the single most common cause of a leak that appears a week after the job.

Halvard R2 two-piston caliper

The R2 is the two-piston caliper and it is the right choice for most road bikes, most commuters, and any rider who is not routinely braking from speed with luggage on. It is lighter than the R4, it has a lighter lever feel, and it costs less to run because the pads are smaller. The body is a single-piece forging. Pistons are phenolic and the same fluid is used across the range, so a workshop only ever stocks one bleed kit. The R2 is supplied with organic pads as standard. Organic pads bed in within a few stops, are quieter, and wear faster, which is a trade most road riders take without noticing they have taken it. Mount is post mount, front or rear. The 2019 R2 body used a different hose fitting and is now superseded; a 2019 caliper being replaced needs a new olive and insert rather than a straight swap of the caliper. Adapters for the R2 have their own part numbers and several of them have been superseded in favour of the universal adapter, which ships with both bolt lengths rather than one.